COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS · OCTOBER 2026

WHERE *KOLLECTS* STANDS, AND WHAT TO BUILD NEXT

A feature, pricing and production-readiness benchmark against eight form, survey and live-polling products, with user-review evidence and a prioritised roadmap.

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Kollects	Google Forms	Microsoft Forms	Jotform
SurveyMonkey	Tally	Mentimeter	Slido

Prepared 15 October 2026 · Benchmarked against Kollects at commit 2d03fd5 · Includes Poll Maker (poll-maker.com) as the eighth competitor · Sources numbered in brackets, full list in Section 11.

1 Executive summary

Kollects is the only product in this set that pairs a Google Forms-class builder (sections, branching, grids, quizzes, file uploads) with real-time Socket.io results *and* India-native UPI payments, at an Indian price point. On raw breadth it trails the field: 32% capability coverage, the lowest of the nine. That is normal for a young product, and the gaps are concentrated, not spread across the core. They are in the **live-room experience** (presenter mode, Q&A, live quiz), the **connective tissue** (embeds, integrations, webhooks, templates), and **self-serve monetisation** (manual plan approval).

32%
Kollects capability coverage
vs 73% Jotform, 53% Slido

0 of 8
competitors do deep forms *and* a live room well
the open space Kollects can own

~115×
more responses per $ than Jotform
Plus: 10,000 resp. for ₹299/mo

6 of 8
competitors drew 'free tier too restrictive' complaints
make generosity a pillar

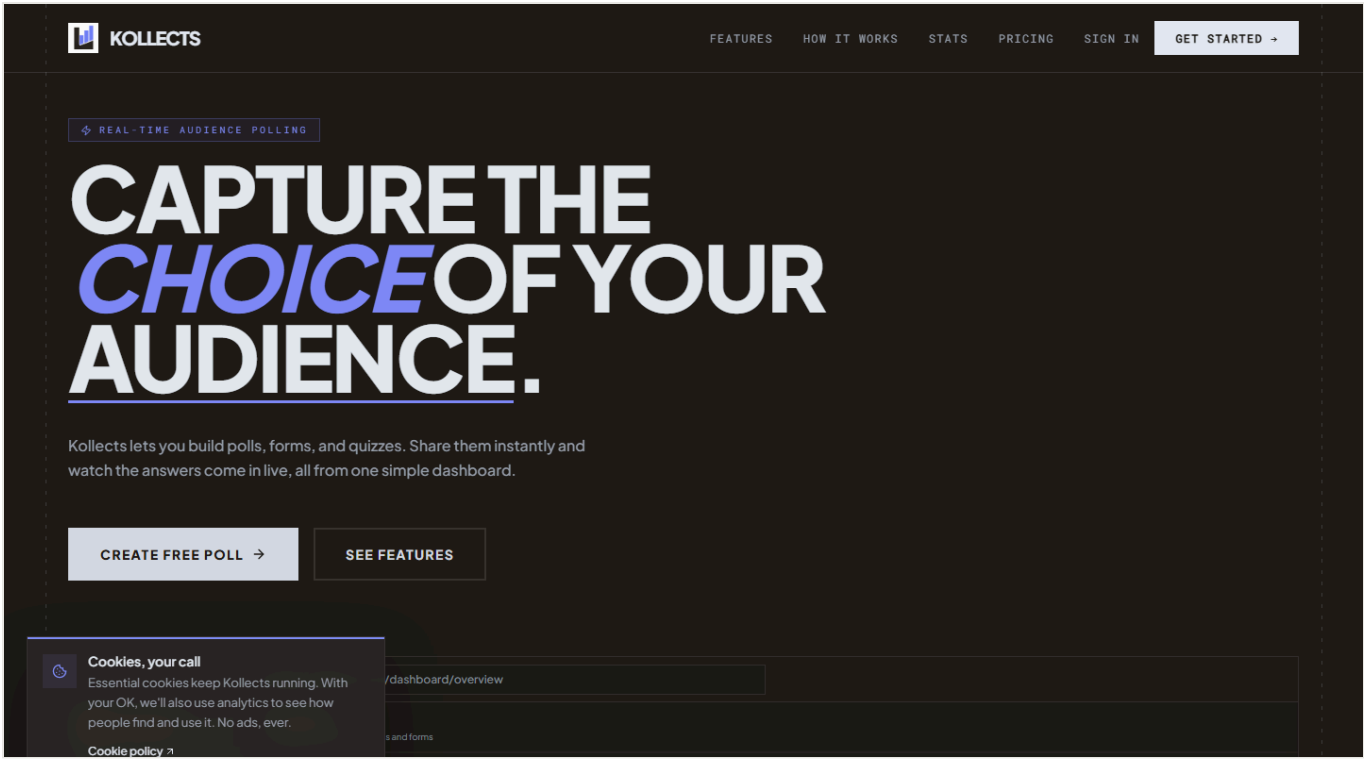
Top findings

1. **Positioning wedge.** No product scores high on both axes (Fig. 1). Form tools (Jotform, Tally, SurveyMonkey, Google) have little live engagement, and live tools (Mentimeter, Slido) can't run a real form. Kollects already has a foothold in both camps, as do Microsoft Forms and Poll Maker. Phases 1–3 of the roadmap would move it into the empty top-right. Lean into "forms *and* live polls in one link".
2. **Biggest functional gap: presenter mode.** A product pitched as "real-time audience polling" has no full-screen presenter view, join code, live Q&A or quiz leaderboard. Mentimeter, Slido and Poll Maker all lead with these.
3. **Second gap: the ecosystem.** No embed, no webhooks/API, no Sheets sync, no Zapier and no templates. Every form competitor has these, most on their free tiers (Tally includes webhooks and Zapier for free).
4. **Pricing is not the problem, but billing is.** At ₹299 for 10,000 responses, Kollects gives about 115× more responses per rupee than Jotform, and about 30× more than SurveyMonkey's India price. Yet upgrades need manual admin approval. Self-serve Razorpay billing is the highest-ROI item in this report.
5. **Generosity wins in this market.** The loudest complaints are restrictive free tiers, hidden responses (SurveyMonkey) and forms switched off at quota (Jotform). Kollects's grace-band design (120% before pausing) is already right. Make "we never hide your data or kill a live form" a promise.
6. **India is under-served.** Google Forms can't take money; global tools price in USD and route payments through Stripe and PayPal. Kollects's UPI support is a genuine local edge. Harden it with verified Razorpay payments.
7. **Production risks to fix before scale:** single-instance sockets and jobs, no CI enforcing the existing tests, no CAPTCHA, and no health checks or error tracking.

2 Method and source notes

- **Competitor sites** were visited on 15 Oct 2026: official pricing and feature pages were fetched for Jotform, Tally, Mentimeter, Slido, SurveyMonkey and Poll Maker, and homepages were screenshotted with headless Chrome. Slido's pricing page renders client-side, so its prices come from Capterra and a July 2026 comparison[7] [8].
- **User sentiment:** Reddit blocks automated access from the research tool used for this report, so threads could not be read directly. Sentiment comes from G2, Capterra, GetApp, TrustRadius, Trustpilot, vendor support forums (Microsoft Q&A, Jotform Answers), and articles that quote Reddit threads (e.g. CostBench and Kimola on SurveyMonkey[27] [28]). Vendor-written comparisons (Jotform, Wooclap) are flagged where used. *Recommended follow-up:* read r/googleforms, r/Teachers, r/SaaS, r/nocode and r/IndiaStartups manually to validate the pain-point ranking in Section 8.
- **Kollects** was assessed from source code (commit 2d03fd5), not marketing copy: plan limits from `config/plans.ts`, question types from `question-types.ts`, and the data model from `form.model.ts` and `poll.model.ts`.
- **Scoring:** the feature matrix uses 2 = available on mainstream plans, 1 = partial, basic or top-tier only, 0 = absent. It is the researcher's assessment from the sources above. Treat ±1 on individual cells as normal disagreement.
- **Currency:** ₹88 = $1 for conversions. All prices are list prices and change frequently. Re-verify before publishing any comparison externally.

3 Kollects today



Kollects landing page (local build, 15 Oct 2026)

Build

- **Polls:** single choice, multiple choice and open-ended; randomise questions and options; anonymous or sign-in mode; expiry date.
- **Forms:** 12 question types (short answer, paragraph, multiple choice, checkboxes, dropdown, linear scale, rating, date, time, MC grid, checkbox grid, file upload); sections; answer-based section jumps; regex, range and length validation; images on questions and options.
- **Quizzes:** points, answer keys, feedback, release score immediately or later.
- **AI assistant** (Mistral): chat to create or extend polls and forms (behind a feature flag).

Collect, analyse, monetise

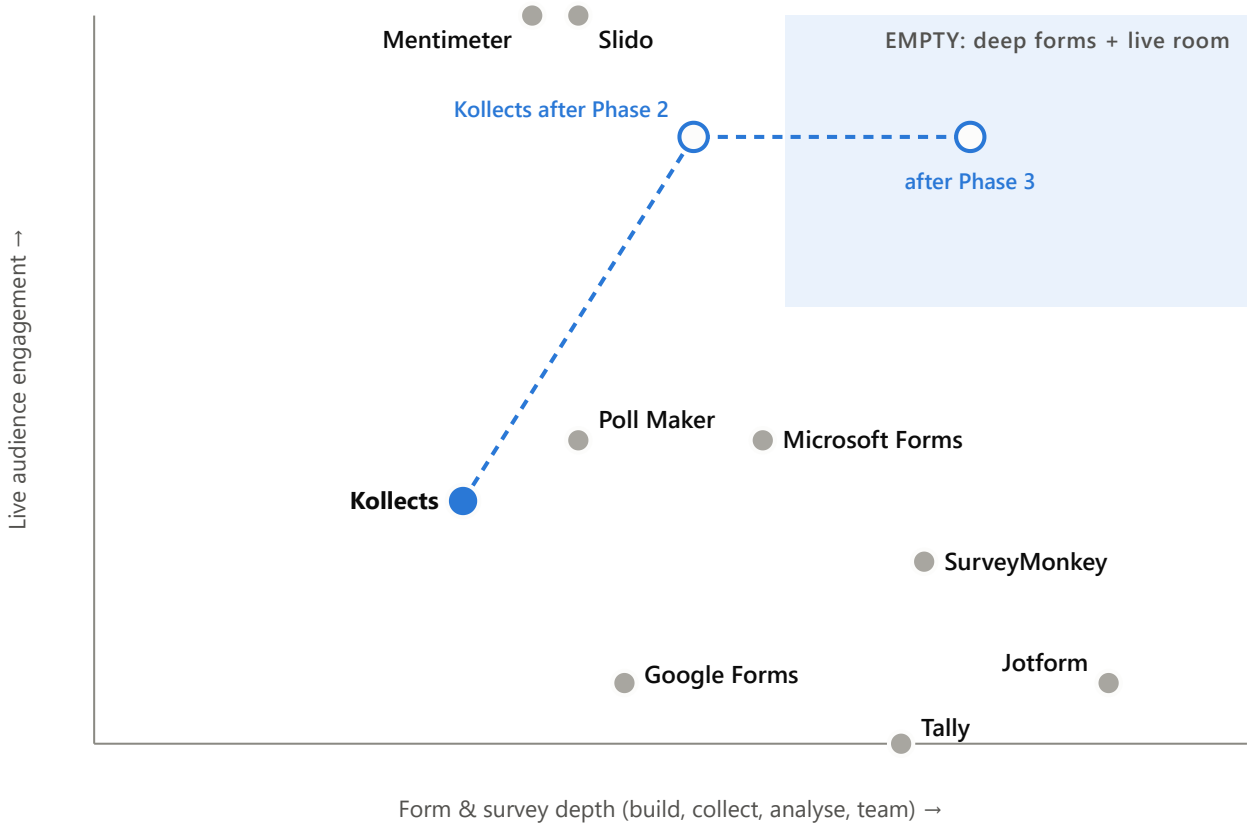
- Share link, QR code, custom slug, social-preview cards, brand kit (logo, accent colour, redirect URL).
- UPI payment questions (amount per option, min/max selections); emailed response receipts.
- Live results over Socket.io, timeline by minute to month, device and browser breakdown, word cloud, PNG snapshot, CSV export, public results page.
- Plans: Free / Plus ₹299 / Pro ₹799, metered monthly on responses, uploads and AI messages, with a 120% grace band. Admin console, consent log and first-party site analytics.

4 Market map

The eight competitors split into two camps. **Form and survey builders** compete on depth: logic, question types, payments and integrations. **Live-engagement tools** compete on the room: presenter view, join codes, Q&A and leaderboards. Nobody owns the top-right corner, and only Microsoft Forms, Poll Maker and Kollects have a foothold in both camps.

Fig. 1: Positioning, form depth vs live engagement

Scores 0–10 computed from the feature matrix in Section 6. Kollects in blue; hollow markers are projections.



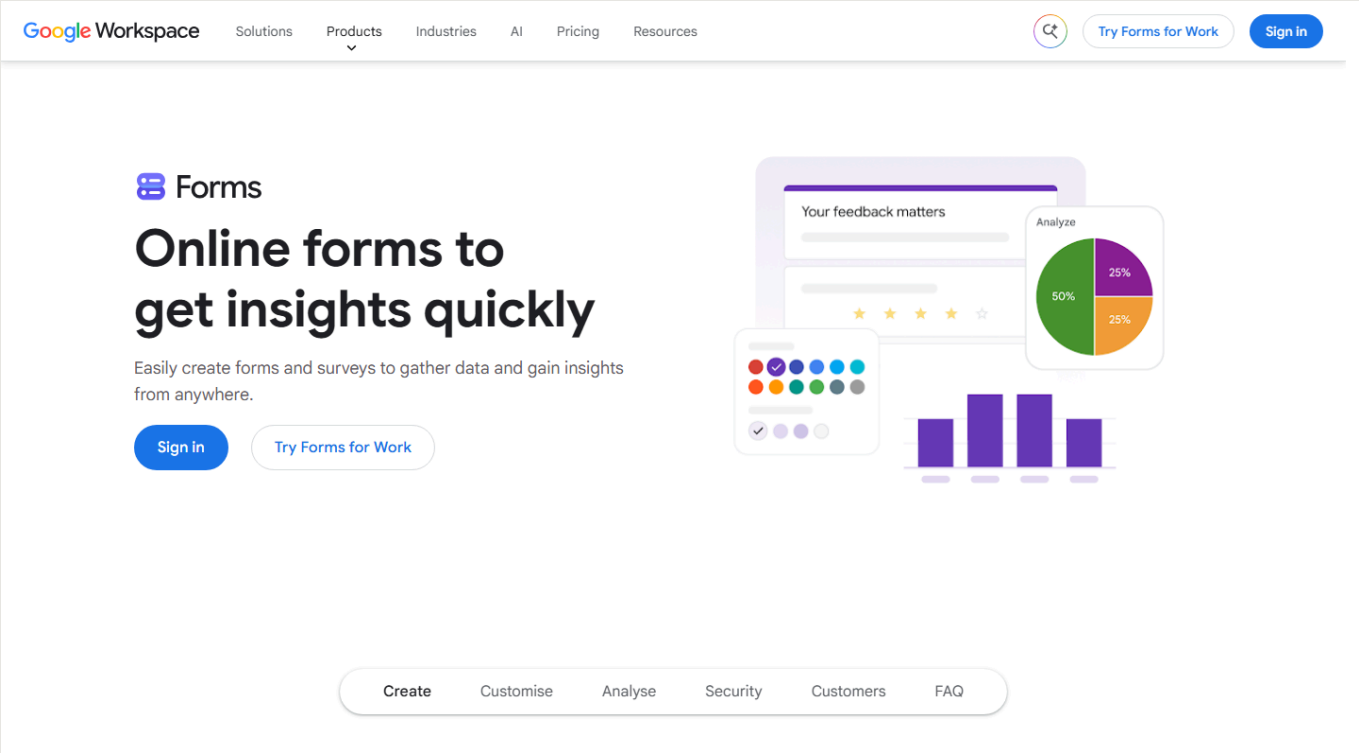
Both axes are computed from the feature matrix (x = all non-live rows, y = "Engage live" rows), so placement updates whenever the matrix does. Today Kollects trails on both axes. The x-axis also counts integrations, analytics and team features, where it is weakest. The hollow markers show the same calculation after the Phase 2 and Phase 3 features ship: they take Kollects into the empty top-right.

Strategic implication. Don't fight Jotform on breadth (they have 20,000 templates and 40 payment gateways) or Slido on enterprise meetings. Win the jobs that need *both*: a college fest that registers attendees (form + UPI fee), then runs live voting on stage; a coaching institute that sells a test (form + payment) and runs a live quiz; a corporate offsite that collects RSVPs and then runs a live Q&A. Today those users stitch Google Forms, a UPI QR code and Mentimeter together[46].

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Google Forms

Free, everywhere, good enough



Google Forms website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Students, teachers, small teams and anyone already in Google Workspace.
Pricing: Free with a Google account. AI (Gemini) features need paid Workspace / Google AI plans.

What they do well

- Unlimited forms and responses at $0, with live sync to Google Sheets
- Quizzes with auto-grading and Google Classroom hand-off
- Real-time co-editing with collaborators; huge add-on marketplace
- Gemini can draft a whole form (and in 2026 quizzes with answer keys) from a prompt or a Drive file [19] [20]

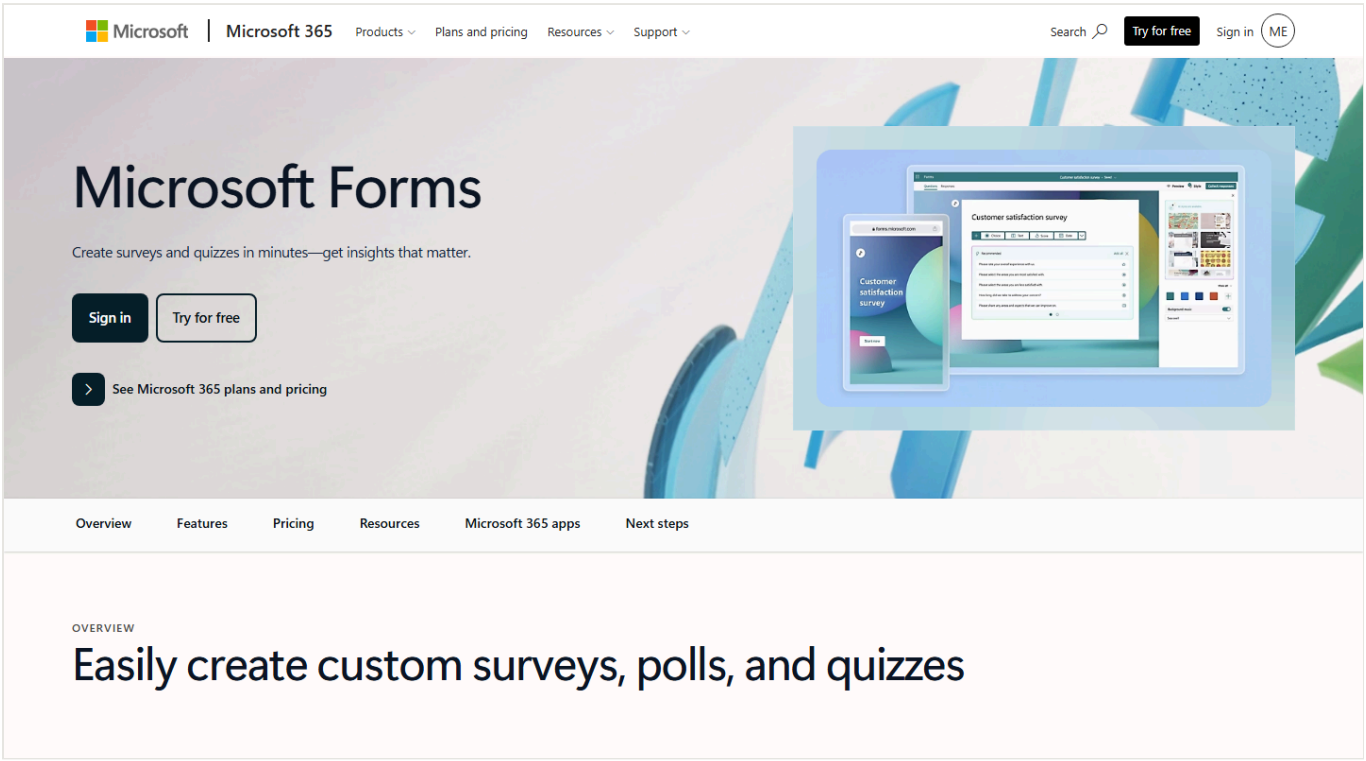
Where users complain

- File-upload questions force respondents to sign in to Google, which blocks many external respondents [21] [22]
- Looks generic: limited fonts, colours and themes; no white-label [23] [25]
- Branching is section-based and gets clunky for multi-path surveys [47]
- Only basic summary analytics, so serious analysis means exporting to Sheets [25]
- No native payments, e-signatures or password protection [25]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Zero-friction free tier + Sheets sync. Kollects already beats it on uploads without login, branding and live results. Make that the headline in your India marketing.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Microsoft Forms The default inside Microsoft 365



Microsoft Forms website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Enterprises, schools and government on Microsoft 365.
Pricing: Free with a Microsoft account; full limits come with Microsoft 365 work/school plans.

What they do well

- Up to 50,000 responses per form and 200 questions on work/school accounts [13]
- Ranking, Likert and NPS question types built in [47]
- Live Excel sync, Power Automate flows, embeds in Teams and SharePoint
- Quizzes with maths equations and practice mode

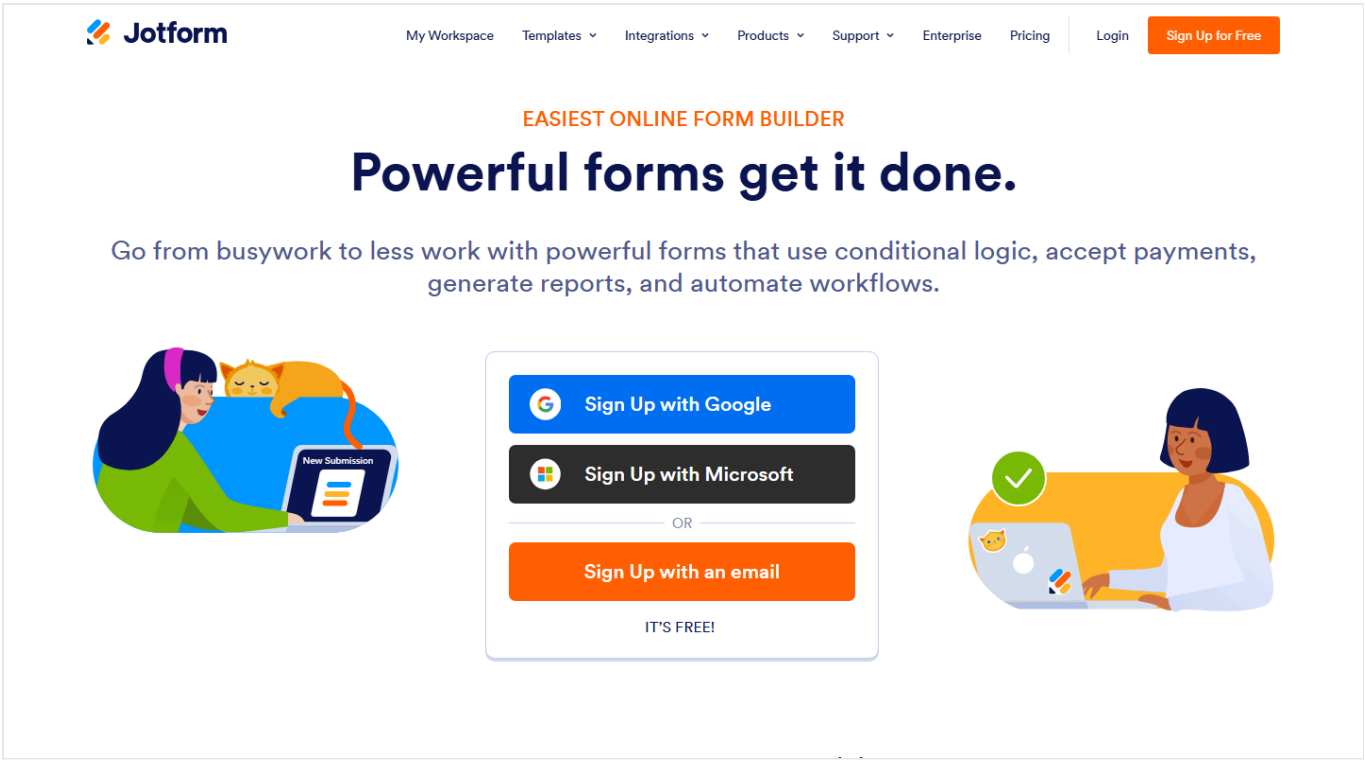
Where users complain

- Personal accounts capped at 200 responses (free) or 1,000 (paid) per form [13]
- Branching only jumps forward and can't branch on multi-select combinations [14] [15] [16]
- Little branding control: no custom fonts, layouts or themes [17]
- Weak integrations outside the Microsoft ecosystem; sharing to named people capped at 100 [17]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Ranking, NPS and Likert questions as first-class types, plus a Teams/Office-style 'Present' button on any poll.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Jotform The feature supermarket



Jotform website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: SMBs, healthcare, NGOs and operations teams who need workflows and payments.
Pricing: Starter $0 (5 forms, 100 subs/mo) · Bronze $39/mo · Silver $49 · Gold $129 · Enterprise custom[1]

What they do well

- 20,000+ templates, 40+ payment gateways, e-signatures, PDF generation[2]
- Approvals and workflows, Tables, Apps, Boards and AI Agents: a whole platform[2]
- HIPAA (Gold), SSO and data residency for enterprise[1]
- Offline mobile app that syncs later; Save & Continue Later[2]

Where users complain

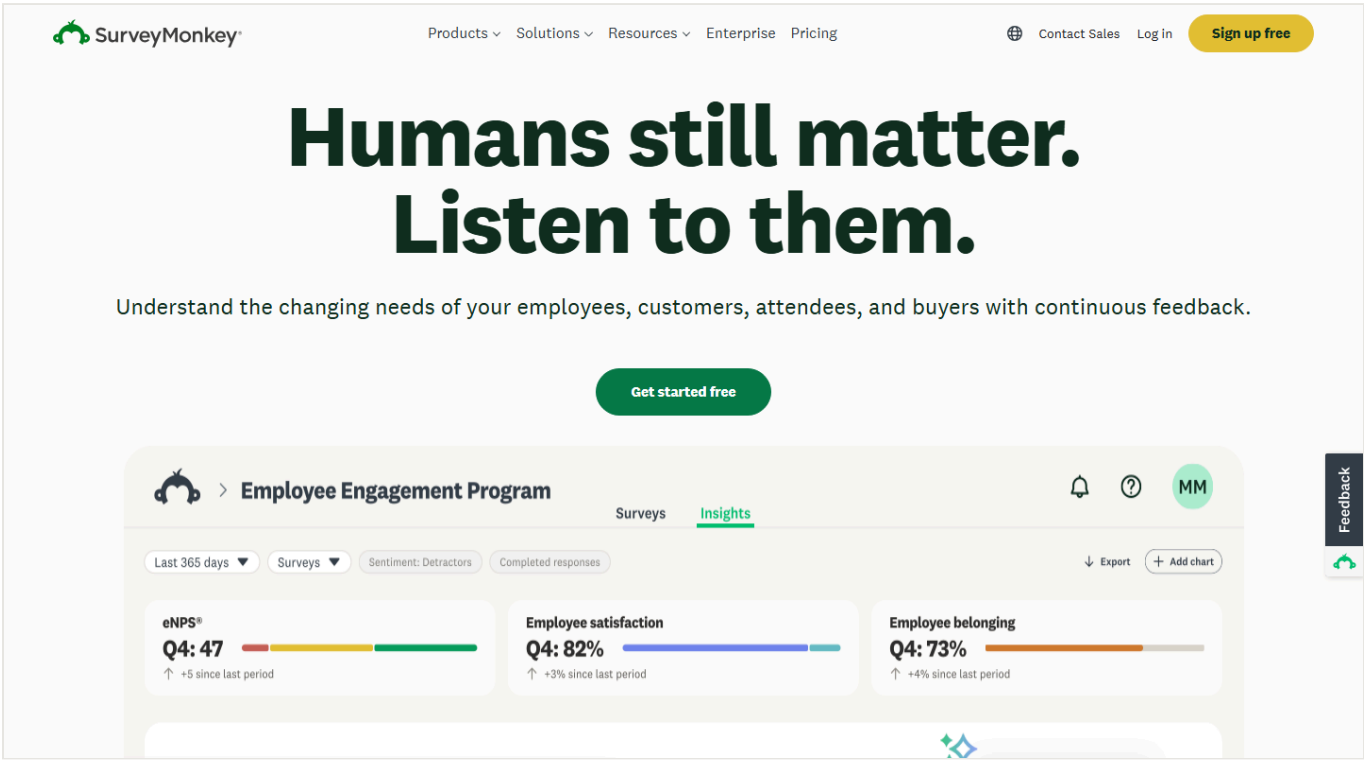
- Five separate meters (forms, submissions, views, payments, storage), and hitting any one disables forms mid-campaign[30][31]
- Big price jumps: there is no tier between 100 and 1,000 submissions[32]
- Every plan below Enterprise is single-user[1]
- Billing complaints: surprise annual renewals, double charges, slow ticket resolution[33]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Templates and payment depth. Avoid its quota model: one meter, plus a soft overage, never a hard switch-off.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

SurveyMonkey

Research-grade surveys, enterprise prices



SurveyMonkey website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Market researchers, HR (eNPS) and CX teams in mid-to-large companies.
Pricing: Basic free (10 questions, capped viewable responses) · India: Standard ₹899/mo, Advantage ₹1,999/mo, Premier ₹4,999/mo · Teams from ₹1,550/user/mo (3-seat minimum)[11][12]

What they do well

- Strongest analytics: crosstabs, significance testing, multi-survey and AI thematic analysis[11]
- Large question bank and templates; Audience panel for buying respondents
- Regional pricing (₹899 in India vs ~$99 in the US) keeps it competitive in local markets[12][27]

Where users complain

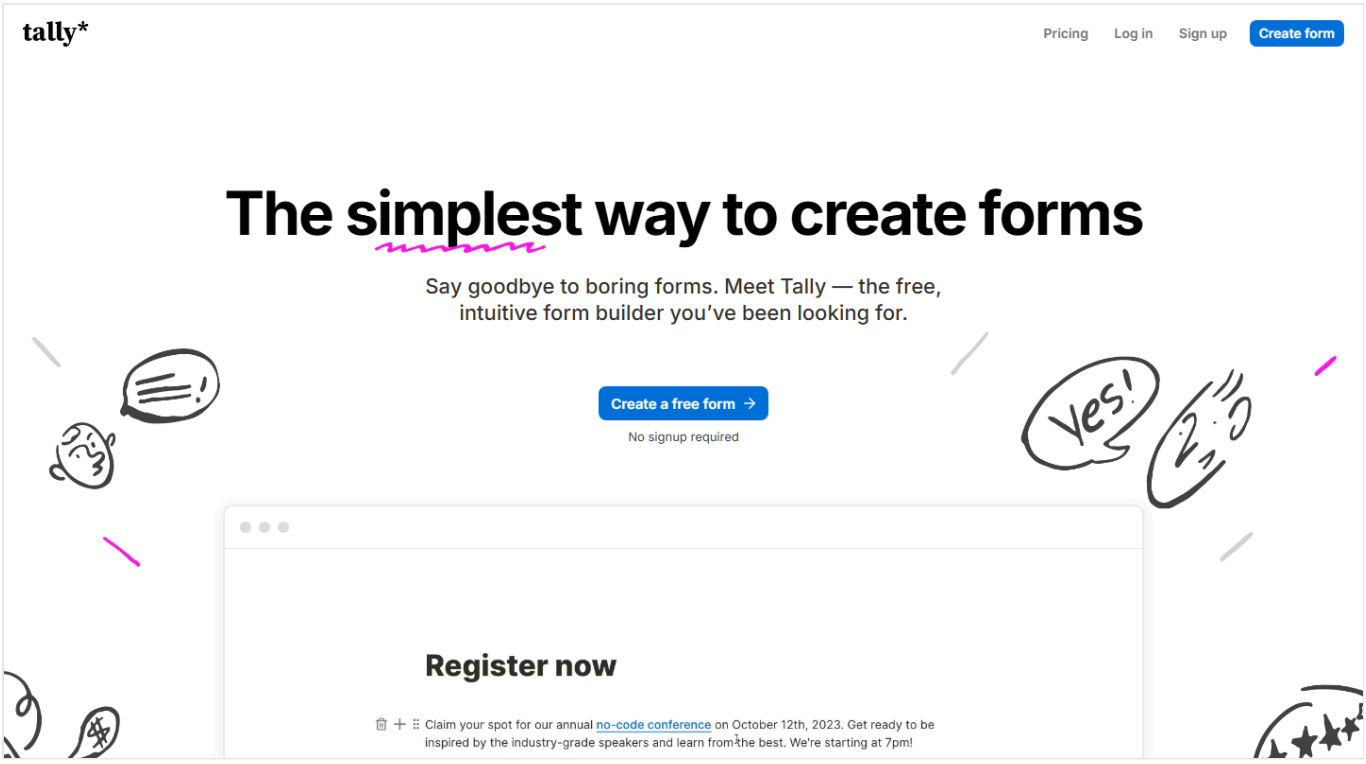
- Free plan collects responses but hides most of them behind a paywall. Reddit users call it a 'scam'[27][28]
- Per-seat team pricing with a 3-seat minimum is hard to justify company-wide[26]
- Overage of ₹5 per response; auto-renewal and cancellation friction[11][28]
- Design flexibility and translations are limited on lower tiers[26]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Crosstabs, filters and AI themes on results. Do the opposite on free: never hide data a user has already collected.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Tally

Notion-style, radically generous free tier



Tally website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Indie makers, startups and no-code builders.
Pricing: Free (unlimited forms and submissions, fair use) · Pro $24/mo · Business $74/mo, billed per workspace, not per seat [3]

What they do well

- Free plan includes logic, calculations, Stripe payments, signatures, uploads, webhooks and Zapier [3]
- Type '/' to add blocks: a document-like builder with almost no learning curve
- Pro adds custom domains, CSS, partial submissions, drop-off analytics and unlimited team members [3]
- 45+ respondent languages with RTL support [3]

Where users complain

- Locked into the 'Tally look'; styling beyond colour, logo and font needs CSS [35]
- Complex branching gets clunky, and there is no visual logic map [35] [36]
- No real-time engagement at all: no live results, presenter mode or quizzes
- 'Unlimited' free usage still has unstated fair-use caps [36]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Workspace-based pricing, a slash-command builder, and putting integrations (webhooks, Sheets) on the free plan.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Mentimeter Interactive presentations



Mentimeter website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Trainers, teachers, facilitators and conference speakers.
Pricing: Free (50 participants/month) · Basic $11.99/presenter/mo · Pro $24.99 (annual only) · Enterprise custom [4]

What they do well

- Slides, polls, word clouds, quizzes and Q&A in one presenter view; join by code, no account [5]
- Menti AI builds a whole interactive deck from a prompt and groups Q&A by theme [5]
- Imports PowerPoint/Keynote/Slides; integrates with Teams, Zoom and LMSs [4] [5]

Where users complain

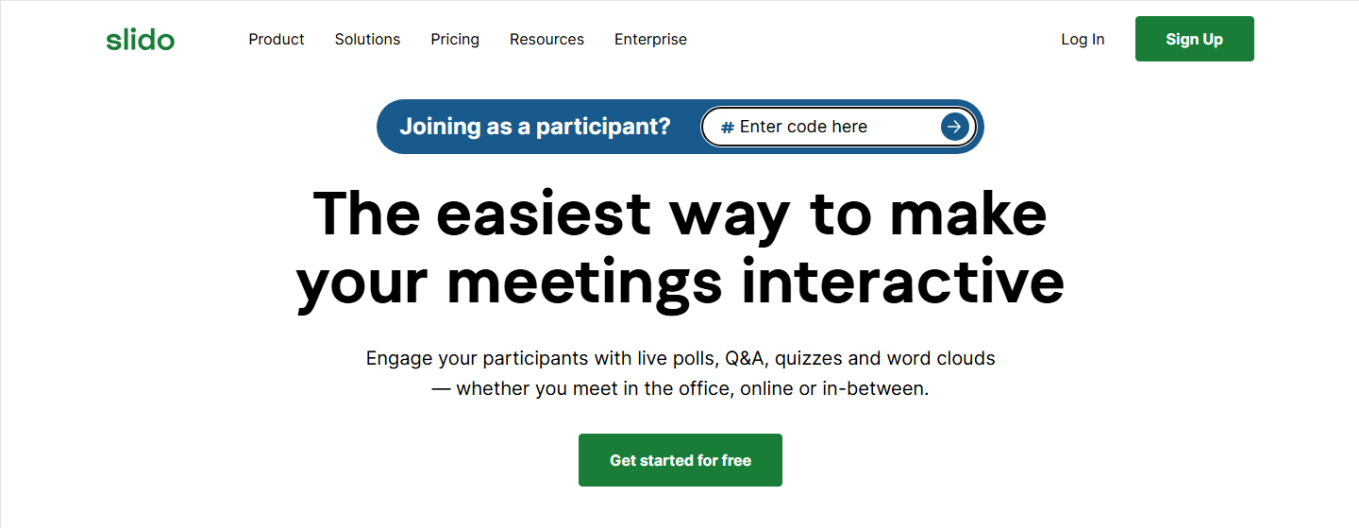
- 50 participants per month on free: two workshops use it up [39] [40]
- Customisation and branding are locked behind Pro; it is the top G2 complaint (105 mentions) [38]
- Per-presenter, annual-only pricing; exports are paid [4] [40]
- Not a form/survey tool: no payments, uploads or deep logic

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Presenter view + join code + live Q&A. This is the single biggest functional gap for a product called 'real-time audience polling'.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Slido

Q&A and polls for meetings (Cisco)



Slido website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Corporate all-hands, town halls, events and webinars.
Pricing: Free (100 participants, 3 polls/event) · Engage ~$17.50/mo · Professional ~$75 · Enterprise ~$200 · one-time event passes ~€60–€499 [7] [8]

What they do well

- Best-in-class audience Q&A: upvotes, moderation, anonymity, sentiment [6]
- Five live poll types (multiple choice, word cloud, rating, open text, ranking) and quizzes with leaderboards [6]
- Deep PowerPoint, Google Slides, Teams, Zoom and Webex integrations [6]
- One-time event passes for organisers who don't want a subscription [8]

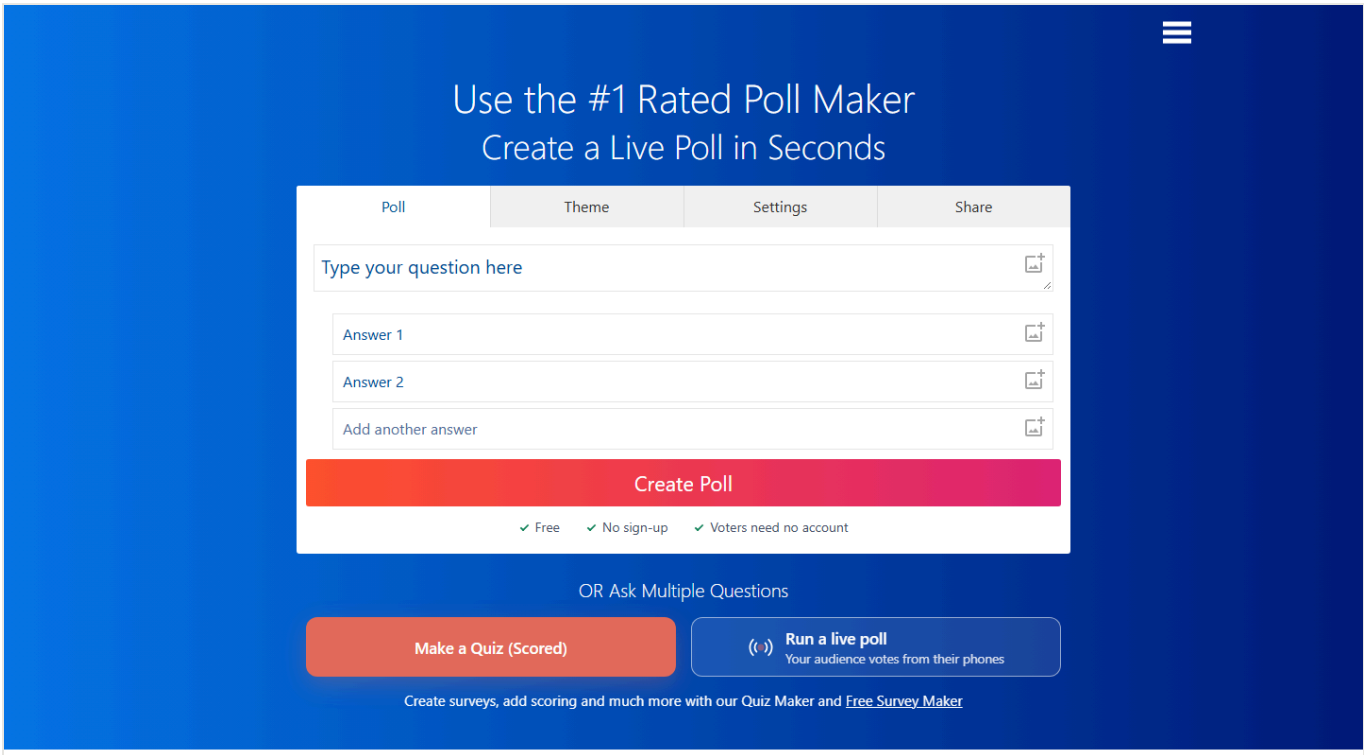
Where users complain

- Steep pricing for single users and non-profits; restricted exports on lower tiers [41]
- The PowerPoint add-in is cumbersome to install and use [43]
- Interactions can't be renamed or re-dated after creation; duplicating questions is hard [42]
- Additional users cost $100–$600 extra [44]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Event-pass pricing and moderated Q&A. Both suit India's college-fest and wedding/event market.

5 · COMPETITOR PROFILE

Poll Maker Single-question polls at scale



Poll Maker website, captured 15 Oct 2026

Who it's for: Bloggers, publishers, communities and social-media polls.
Pricing: Free (unlimited polls and votes, with a badge) · Starter $37/mo · Professional $59 · Team $179 (annual: $29/$49/$149) [9] [10]

What they do well

- Create a poll from the homepage with no sign-up; voters need no account [9]
- Fraud scoring: suspicious votes are silently discounted so manipulators get no signal [9]
- Embed anywhere and combine results across platforms; geo-IP maps; scheduled start/stop [9] [10]
- 38 question types, certificates and a REST API on higher tiers [10]

Where users complain

- Dated UI and ad-like experience on the free tier
- Survey/quiz responses capped at 100/month on the $37 Starter plan [10]
- Images/video and advanced features locked on free [49]

> **Lesson for Kollects:** Zero-signup poll creation on the landing page, embeddable widgets, and invisible vote-fraud scoring.

6 Feature gap matrix

32 capabilities × 9 products. Rows in **orange** are the clearest gaps: Kollects scores 0 where at least one competitor scores 2.

● Full ◐ Partial / top tier only – Absent

Capability	Kollects	Google Forms	MS Forms	Jotform	SurveyMonkey	Tally	Mentimeter	Slido	Poll Maker
BUILD									
Question-type breadth (15+ types)	◐	◐	◐	●	●	●	◐	◐	●
Ranking / NPS / Likert questions	◐	◐	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
Question-level conditional logic	◐	◐	●	●	●	●	–	–	◐
Calculations & answer piping	–	–	–	●	◐	●	–	–	◐
Template gallery	–	◐	◐	●	●	◐	●	◐	◐
AI: generate form from prompt	●	◐	◐	●	●	–	●	●	–
AI: summarise / theme open answers	–	◐	◐	◐	◐	–	◐	◐	–
COLLECT									
Payments inside the form	◐	–	–	●	◐	●	–	–	–
E-signature field	–	–	–	●	–	●	–	–	–
File upload without respondent login	●	–	◐	●	◐	●	–	–	–
Save & resume / partial responses	–	◐	–	●	◐	◐	–	–	–
Multi-language forms	–	–	●	●	◐	●	◐	◐	◐
Bot / fraud protection (CAPTCHA, scoring)	◐	◐	◐	●	◐	◐	◐	◐	●
Embed on any website	–	●	●	●	●	●	◐	●	●
Custom domain / slug	◐	–	–	◐	◐	◐	–	–	–
Branding / white-label	◐	◐	◐	◐	◐	◐	◐	◐	◐
Native mobile app / offline	–	–	◐	●	●	–	◐	◐	–
ENGAGE LIVE									
Real-time results	●	◐	●	◐	◐	–	●	●	●
Presenter mode + join code	–	–	◐	–	–	–	●	●	●
Live Q&A with upvotes & moderation	–	–	–	–	–	–	●	●	–
Word cloud	●	–	–	–	◐	–	●	●	–
Live quiz with timer & leaderboard	–	–	–	–	–	–	●	●	◐
PowerPoint / Slides / Teams / Zoom	–	–	●	–	◐	–	●	●	–
ANALYSE & CONNECT									
Export (CSV / Excel / PDF)	◐	●	●	●	◐	●	◐	◐	◐
Advanced analytics (filters, crosstabs)	◐	–	–	◐	●	◐	◐	◐	◐
Native integrations (Sheets, Slack, CRM)	–	●	●	●	●	●	◐	●	●
Webhooks / API / Zapier	–	◐	●	●	●	●	–	◐	●
Email notifications & autoresponders	●	◐	◐	●	◐	●	–	–	◐
TEAM & TRUST									
Team workspaces & roles	–	●	●	◐	●	●	◐	◐	◐
SSO / enterprise admin	–	●	●	◐	◐	–	◐	◐	–
Compliance tooling (GDPR/HIPAA/retention)	◐	●	●	●	●	◐	◐	◐	–
Coverage score	32%	39%	55%	73%	63%	56%	50%	53%	42%

Fig. 2: Overall capability coverage

Share of the maximum possible score across the 32 capabilities in the matrix.

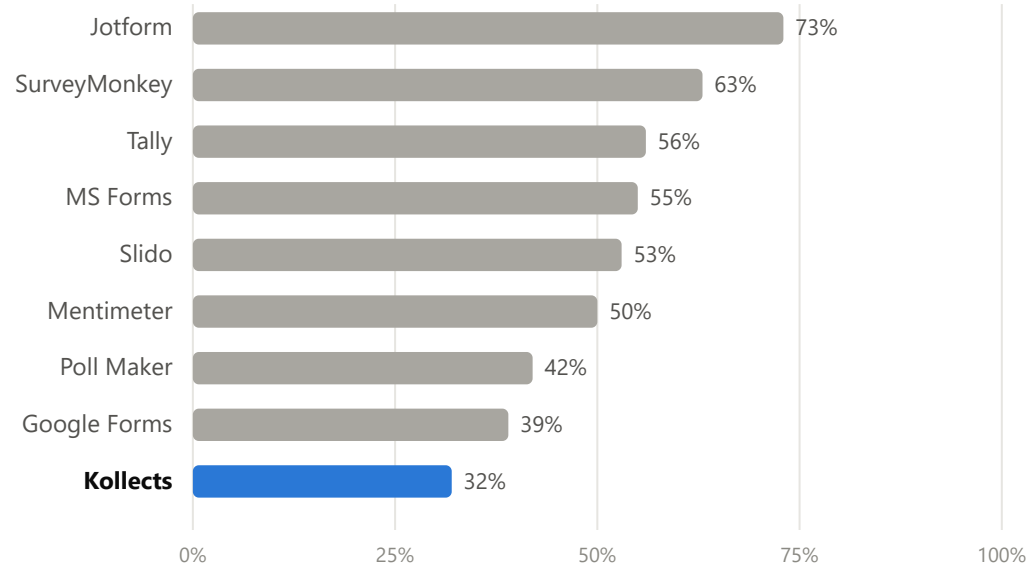
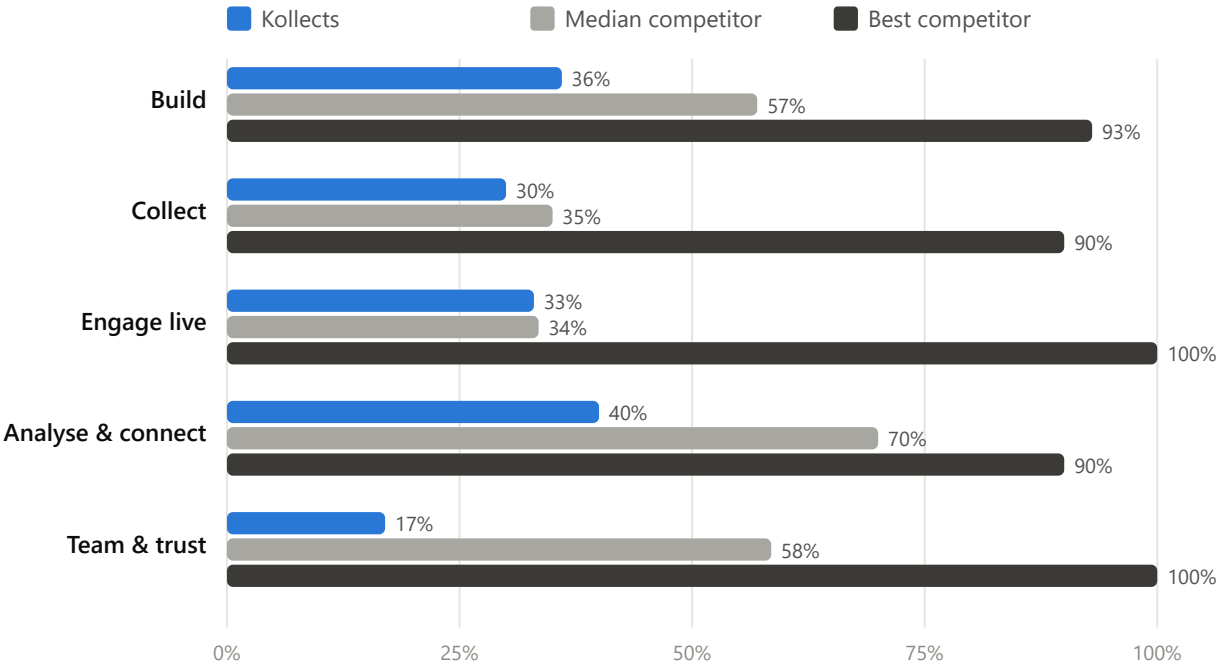


Fig. 3: Coverage by capability group

Kollects vs the median and the best competitor in each group.



Kollects is near the median in **Collect** (30% vs 35%) and matches it in **Engage live** (33% vs 34%), where Mentimeter and Slido score 100%. The widest gaps are **Team & trust** (17% vs 58%: no workspaces or SSO), **Analyse & connect** (40% vs 70%: no integrations or API) and **Build** (36% vs 57%: no templates, calculations or question-level logic).

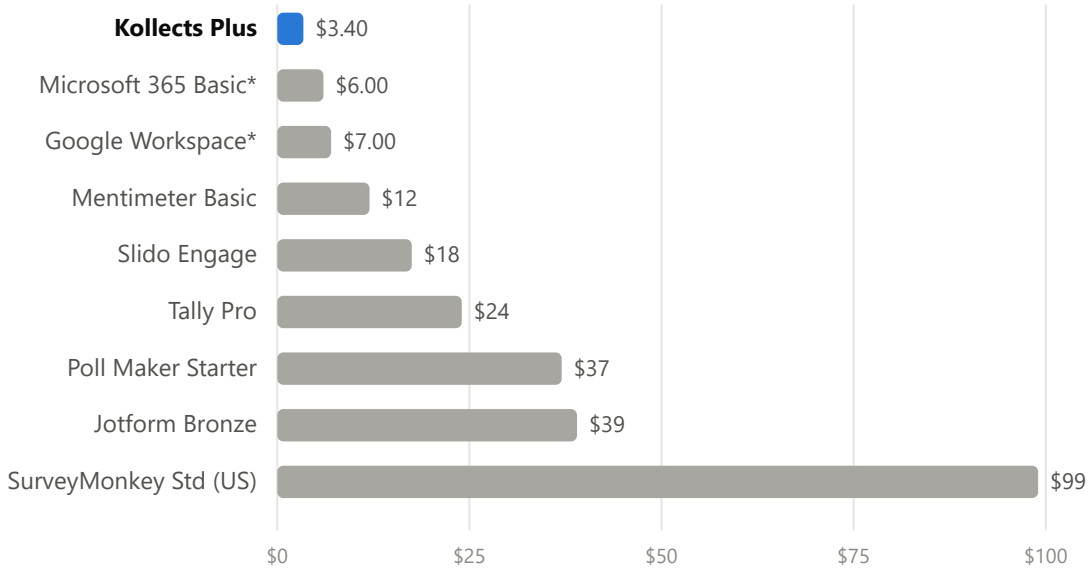
7 Pricing analysis

Product	Free tier	Entry paid	Mid / Pro	Billing unit
Kollects	1,000 responses/mo, 10 live items, 100 uploads, 30 AI msgs	Plus ₹299/mo (₹2,990/yr): 10k responses, slug, branding	Pro ₹799/mo: 100k responses, unlimited live	Per account (manual upgrade approval)
Google Forms	Unlimited forms & responses	Workspace ~$7/user/mo*	Gemini needs Business Standard+	Per user (bundled)
Microsoft Forms	200 responses/form (personal)	M365 Basic ~$6/user/mo*: 50k/form	Copilot add-on	Per user (bundled)
Jotform	5 forms, 100 subs/mo, 100 MB	Bronze $39/mo ($34 annual): 25 forms, 1k subs	Silver $49, Gold $129 (HIPAA)	Single user per account
SurveyMonkey	10 questions, limited viewable responses	Standard ₹899/mo (India), 1k/mo	Advantage ₹1,999, Premier ₹4,999 (annual)	Per user; teams 3-seat min
Tally	Unlimited forms & submissions (fair use)	Pro $24/mo	Business $74/mo	Per workspace, unlimited members
Mentimeter	50 participants/month	Basic $11.99/presenter/mo	Pro $24.99 (annual only)	Per presenter
Slido	100 participants, 3 polls/event	Engage ~$17.50/mo	Professional ~$75, Enterprise ~$200; event passes €60–€499	Per user / per event
Poll Maker	Unlimited polls & votes (badge)	Starter $37/mo ($29 annual)	Professional $59, Team $179	Per account

* Google and Microsoft prices are the cheapest business suite that includes the form tool; the form tool itself is not sold separately. Prices are list prices captured Oct 2026 and are geo-served (SurveyMonkey showed INR; others USD/EUR). Third-party sources disagree on several figures; vendor pages were used where reachable.

Fig. 4: Entry paid plan, USD/month

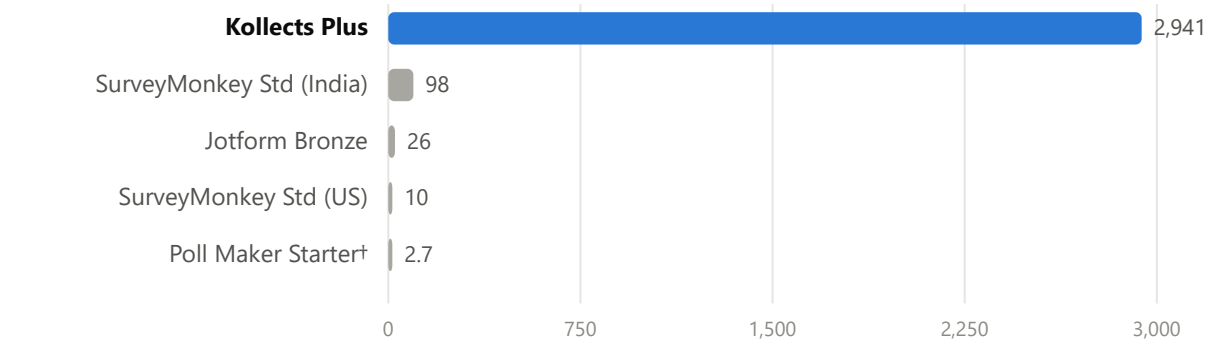
Cheapest paid tier, list price, monthly where offered.



* Suite price that includes the form tool.

Fig. 5: Responses per $1 at entry paid tier

Included monthly responses ÷ monthly price. Only products that meter responses.



† Poll Maker meters survey/quiz responses (100/mo); its single-question polls are unlimited.

Pricing findings

- **Kollects is the cheapest paid product in the set**, by roughly 30× (SurveyMonkey India) to 115× (Jotform) per response against metered competitors. That wins price-sensitive Indian users, but it may signal "toy" to institutions and leaves revenue on the table at the Pro tier.
- **Free-tier generosity is polarised.** Google Forms and Tally give unlimited responses. Jotform (100/mo), Mentimeter (50 participants/mo) and SurveyMonkey (hidden responses) are the most-criticised. Kollects's 1,000/mo sits in between. That is fine, as long as limits never hide data or switch off a live form.
- **Competitors localise.** SurveyMonkey shows ₹899 in India against ~$99 in the US. Expect global tools to price-match locally, so price alone is not a durable moat.
- **Billing units matter.** Per-seat pricing (SurveyMonkey, Mentimeter, Slido) is a top complaint. Tally's per-workspace model with unlimited members is praised.

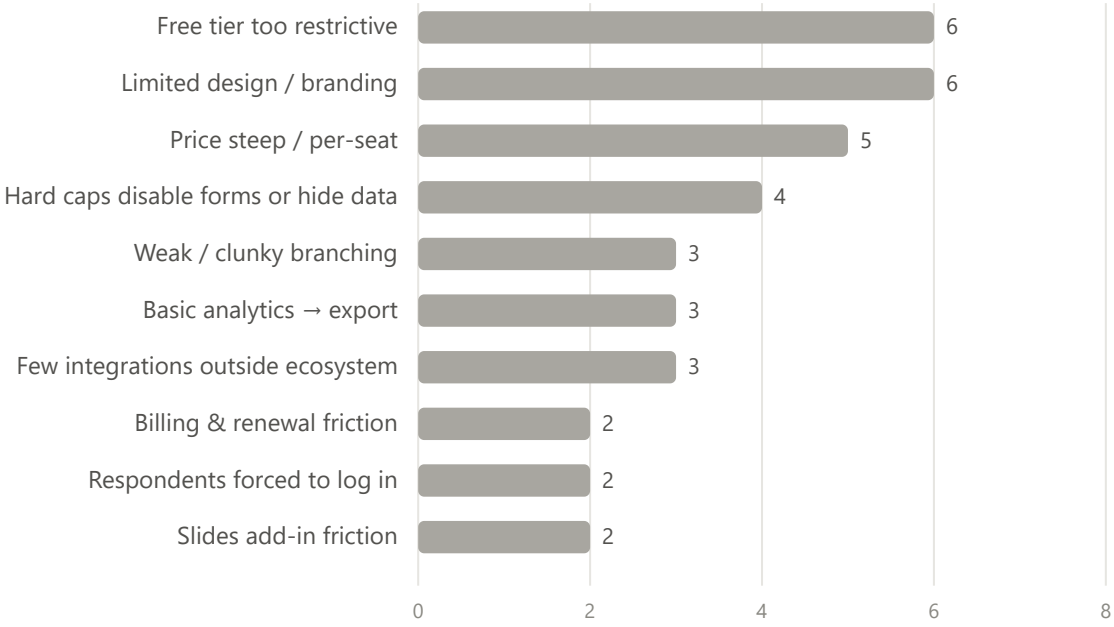
Pricing recommendations

Change	Detail	Evidence
Self-serve checkout	Razorpay Subscriptions with UPI Autopay, cards and netbanking; instant upgrade; GST invoices; proration. Keep manual approval only for invoiced B2B deals.	Manual approval in `plan-request.service.ts`
Event Pass (one-time)	₹199 / ₹499 / ₹999 for 7 days of Pro-level limits, sized by audience (500 / 2,000 / 10,000). Built for fests, weddings, conferences and webinars.	Slido one-time passes €60–€499 [8]
Team tier	₹1,999/mo per workspace with 5 seats included (₹299 per extra seat), roles, shared brand kit and folders. Avoid hard per-seat minimums.	Per-seat complaints [26] [44]; Tally model [3]
Education plan	Verified teachers and student clubs get Plus free or at ₹99/mo. This seeds word-of-mouth in campuses.	Mentimeter and Slido run EDU plans [4]
Raise Pro value, not price	Put presenter mode, Q&A, integrations and PDF reports in Pro. Then test ₹999.	Fig. 5: large headroom
International PPP	USD pricing for non-INR visitors (e.g. $6 / $15 / $39 Team).	Geo-served pricing is standard [12]
Data promise	Publish it: "Over your limit? We keep collecting for a grace period and never hide responses you already have."	SurveyMonkey and Jotform complaints [27] [31]

8 What users hate, and where Kollects can win

Fig. 6: Complaint themes across the eight competitors

Number of competitors (of 8) where the theme recurs in reviews, support forums or Reddit-quoting articles. Coded by the researcher from the sources in each profile.



Pain point	Who suffers from it	Kollects response
Free tier too restrictive / data held hostage	SurveyMonkey, Jotform, Mentimeter, Slido	Keep the 1,000/mo free tier and the grace band; never hide data; show a usage meter early (already in `usage-banner`).
Generic look, branding paywalled	Google, Microsoft, Tally, Mentimeter, Slido	The brand kit exists. Add theme presets, font choice and a "remove Powered by" toggle on Plus.
Forms switched off at quota	Jotform, Mentimeter	Already soft (120% grace). Make it explicit in marketing; email at 80% (already implemented).
Respondents forced to log in	Google (uploads), Microsoft (org)	Anonymous uploads already work. Advertise "no Google account needed".
Clunky branching	Google, Microsoft, Tally	Add question-level show/hide rules and a visual logic map in the builder.
Can't take money (India)	Google, Microsoft, Mentimeter, Slido	UPI is already in. Add verified Razorpay payments, receipts and a paid-status filter.
Slides add-in friction	Slido, Mentimeter	Lead with a browser presenter view that works in any screen-share. Build the add-in later.

9 Production readiness gaps

These come from reading the Kollects codebase. They don't show in a feature comparison, but they decide whether the product survives its first big event or customer.

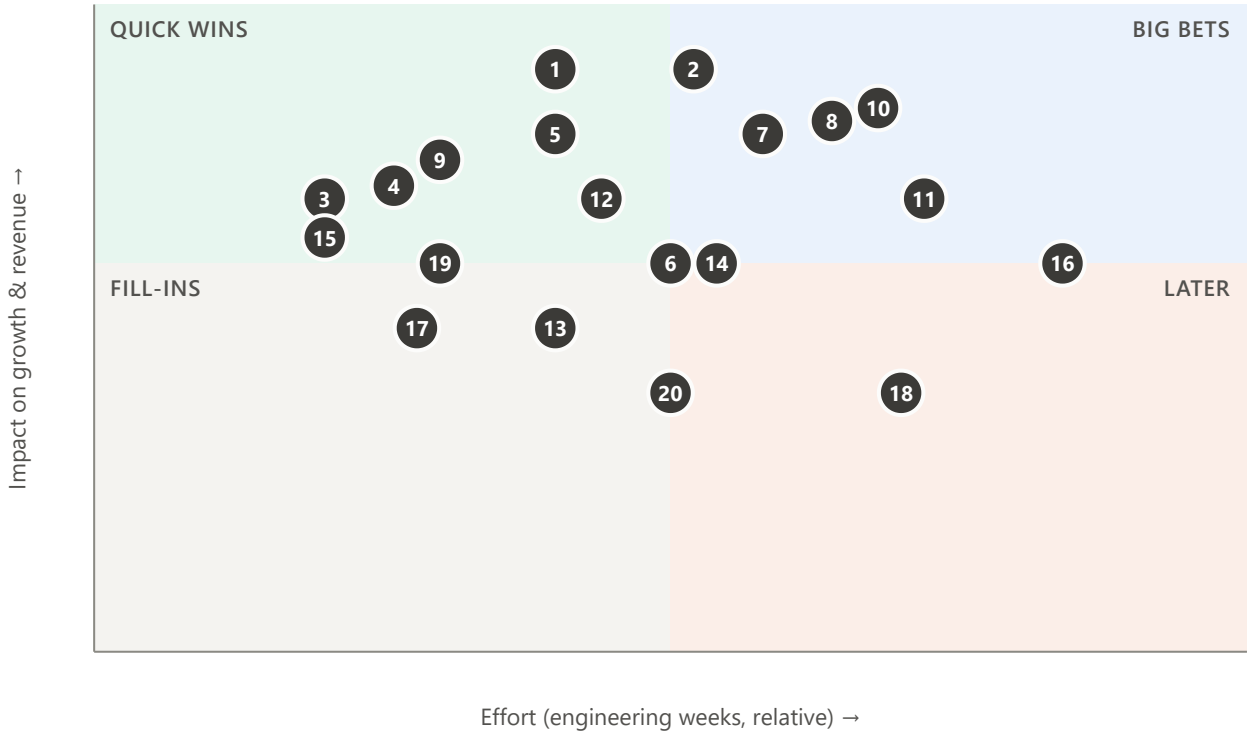
Area	What the code does today	Risk	Fix
Billing	Upgrades go through a *plan request* that an admin approves manually (`plan-request.service.ts`); no payment gateway.	Lost conversions; can't scale beyond a few customers; no dunning or renewals.	Razorpay Subscriptions (UPI Autopay + cards), webhook-driven plan changes.
Form payments	UPI deep link with a reference in the note (`payment.util.ts`); creator matches payments by hand.	No proof of payment; refunds and disputes impossible to audit.	Optional Razorpay order per response; mark paid via webhook.
Horizontal scale	Socket.io uses the in-memory adapter; poll expiry is an in-process `setInterval` (`expiry.job.ts`).	A second instance splits live rooms and double-runs jobs; a restart drops every live session.	`@socket.io/redis-adapter`; a DB lock or a queue (BullMQ) for jobs.
Abuse	Rate limits on auth/responses; IP-hash dedup only in production.	Public polls are easy to brigade with rotating IPs; signup spam.	Cloudflare Turnstile on public submit + server-side vote-fraud score.
Delivery	42 test files (Vitest) exist, but there is no CI workflow in the repo.	Regressions ship unnoticed; the tests don't gate merges.	GitHub Actions: lint, typecheck, test on every PR.
Observability	Custom request metrics plus an admin dashboard; no health endpoint or external error tracking.	Outages are found by users first; hosting can't health-check the service.	`/healthz`, Sentry, uptime monitor, public status page.
Data protection	Cookie-consent log and first-party analytics with consent gating (good). No retention or auto-delete controls for responses.	India's DPDP Act and GDPR expect retention limits, erasure on request, and a DPA for business buyers.	Per-form retention, respondent erasure, published DPA and sub-processor list.

> **Single biggest operational risk:** a viral poll or a large live event. Without the Redis adapter, CAPTCHA and health checks, you can't add a second instance, bots can skew results, and nobody gets paged when it goes down. Phase 1 fixes all three in about a week of work.

10 Recommendations

Fig. 7: Impact vs effort, 20 candidate features

Numbers match the table below. Impact = expected effect on activation, conversion and retention. Effort is relative.



#	Feature	Imp.	Eff.
1	Self-serve billing via Razorpay (UPI Autopay, cards)	9	4
2	Presenter mode: full-screen live view + 6-digit join code	9	5.2
3	Template gallery (50+ India-relevant templates)	7	2
4	Embed widget (iframe + script) for polls & forms	7.2	2.6
5	Webhooks + Google Sheets live sync	8	4
6	Zapier / Make app	6	5
7	Live Q&A with upvotes & moderation	8	5.8
8	Live quiz: timer, streaks, leaderboard	8.2	6.4
9	AI summaries & themes of open answers (Mistral already wired)	7.6	3
10	Verified payments: Razorpay order + webhook, not just UPI deep link	8.4	6.8

#	Feature	Imp.	Eff.
11	Team workspaces, roles & shared folders	7	7.2
12	New types: ranking, NPS, matrix, signature, hidden fields, calculations	7	4.4
13	Save & resume / partial responses	5	4
14	Multi-language forms (Hindi + regional, RTL)	6	5.4
15	Cloudflare Turnstile + vote-fraud scoring	6.4	2
16	PowerPoint / Google Slides add-in	6	8.4
17	PDF report export of results	5	2.8
18	SSO (SAML/Google Workspace), audit logs	4	7
19	Scale-out: Socket.io Redis adapter + locked expiry job	6	3
20	Installable PWA with offline collection	4	5

Roadmap

Phase	Ship	Why now
Phase 1 · Weeks 0–6 **Make it sellable**	#1 Razorpay billing · #15 Turnstile + fraud score · #19 Redis adapter + job lock · #3 Templates · #4 Embed widget · #9 AI summaries · CI + /healthz + Sentry	All quick wins. Turns manual upgrades into revenue and makes the platform safe to put in front of a large audience.
Phase 2 · Weeks 6–14 **Own the live room**	#2 Presenter mode + join code · #7 Live Q&A · #8 Live quiz leaderboard · #5 Webhooks + Sheets · #17 PDF report	Closes the biggest gap against Mentimeter and Slido while keeping the form depth they lack. This is the positioning wedge.
Phase 3 · Months 4–6 **Depth & teams**	#12 New question types · #10 Verified payments · #11 Workspaces & roles · #14 Hindi/regional languages · #13 Partial responses · #6 Zapier	Unlocks the Team tier and B2B buyers (colleges, event agencies, coaching institutes).
Phase 4 · Month 6+ **Enterprise & reach**	#16 Slides/PPT add-in · #18 SSO + audit log · #20 PWA offline · Data residency / DPA	Only once there is demand from paying teams. Expensive to build and maintain.

Streamlining the product

1. **One object, three modes.** Polls and forms are separate modules end to end (`poll/response/analytics` vs `form/form-response/form-analytics`), two builders and two analytics pages. Users must choose before they start. Merge them into one "Kollect" with a mode switch: *Survey* (self-paced), *Live* (presenter-paced) and *Quiz* (scored). A poll becomes a one-question form. That gives one builder, one results page, one share panel, and half the code to maintain.
2. **Three doors to create:** Template, AI prompt, or Blank, on one screen. Feed the onboarding "intent" answer straight into the template it suggests.
3. **One share panel:** link, slug, QR, embed code, social preview and "Present" in one dialog. Today these are spread across the builder success step, the branding page and the analytics QR dialog.
4. **Zero-signup first poll** (Poll Maker, Tally): let visitors build and share a poll from the landing hero, then claim it on sign-up. This shortens time-to-value from minutes to seconds.
5. **Results that act:** filter by answer, compare segments, AI summary at the top, and one-click PDF/CSV. Most competitors stop at charts.
6. **Billing inside the product:** the upgrade button opens Razorpay checkout in place, not a request form.

What not to build (yet)

- A Jotform-style platform (Apps, Tables, Boards, Store builder): huge surface area and not your wedge.
- SurveyMonkey-grade statistics (significance testing, panels): research buyers aren't your early market.
- Native mobile apps: a PWA covers it until offline field collection is a proven need.

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